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ORACLE PCMCS TRAINING MANUAL

Profitability and Cost Management Cloud Service (PCMCS) Implementation Guide

Training Title:	Enterprise Analytics, Visualizations, and Executive Dashboards	**Document Version:**	1.0 (Official University Edition)
PCMCS Module:	Dashboards & Management Reporting Intelligence	**Prepared By:**	BISP Solutions Expert Team
Primary Topic:	Custom PCMCS Dashboard Canvas ("Six Months Trending Analysis")	**Date:**	August 4, 2026
Application Context:	Fusion Cloud EPM PCMCS: `BksML30`	**Target Audience:**	Consultants, Architects, Developers, Aspirants

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1. Introduction

Welcome to the official training guide for **Oracle Enterprise Performance Management (EPM) Profitability and Cost Management Cloud Service (PCMCS) Dashboards**, crafted by BISP Solutions.

In modern enterprise profitability management, executive leadership requires the immediate transformation of dense, multi-dimensional allocation outputs into clear, visual, and actionable analytical insights. PCMCS Dashboards provide a dynamic visual canvas aggregating data from Essbase multi-dimensional cubes (BSO/ASO), Smart View reports, and Profitability Curves into real-time visual charts, KPI tiles, and trending analysis.

This document comprehensively analyzes the custom Dashboard view **"Six Months Trending Analysis | Department Stores"** within application `BksML30`.

2. Learning Objectives

- **Navigate & Master UI:** Interact effectively with the primary Dashboards workspace within Oracle PCMCS.
- **Configure Visual Widgets:** Build Line Charts, Bar Graphs, and Quarter-over-Quarter KPI Status Tiles linked to dynamic forms.
- **Essbase Integration:** Understand how dashboard tiles map to Essbase slice intersections in application `BksML30`.
- **Performance Optimization:** Apply Oracle best practices to ensure sub-second rendering across high-density enterprise cubes.
- **Troubleshoot & Audit:** Resolve missing data, cache mismatches, and POV alignment issues efficiently.
- **Certification & Job Readiness:** Master real-world implementation scenarios, interview questions, and certification MCQs.

3. Primary Topic Identification & UI Overview

The core feature highlighted in this guide is the **PCMCS Executive Dashboards View** located under the primary **Dashboards** navigation card.

```
+------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------
+
|  ORACLE  Fusion Cloud EPM Profitability and Cost Management: BksML30
[Home] [User] [APITest] |
+------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------
+
|  [Dashboards]  [Intelligence]  [Reports]
[Academy]                                                                     |
+------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------
+
|  Six Months Trending Analysis | Department
Stores                                               [POV/Actions] [Close] [Refresh] |
|
|
|  +--------------------------+  +--------------------------+  +--------------------------
+                          |
|  | Net Income % | Chain      |  | Change Over Prior Quarter |  | Change Over Prior Quarter
|                          |
|  | [Line Chart: BB100, etc.] |  | [+0.19%]                  |  | [-7.53%]
|                          |
|  +--------------------------+  +--------------------------+  +--------------------------
+                          |
|  +--------------------------+  +--------------------------+  +--------------------------
+                          |
|  | Net Income % | QMart      |  | Net Income % | Sporting   |  | Net Income % | Mountain
|                          |
|  | [Line Chart: B1001-B1004]  |  | [Line Chart: B1001-B1004]  |  | [Line Chart: B1001-B1004]
|                          |
|  +--------------------------+  +--------------------------+  +--------------------------
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```

Key Identifying Metrics

- **Application Context:** Fusion Cloud EPM Profitability and Cost Management (PCMCS): `BksML30`
- **Active Tab:** Dashboards Workspace
- **Canvas Title:** Six Months Trending Analysis | Department Stores
- **Grid Layout:** 2x3 Grid Container (4 Line Chart Widgets + 2 Status/Variance KPI Tiles)

4. Progressive Learning Path

Beginner Level

Dashboards provide a visual user interface for reviewing financial metrics stored in PCMCS. Rather than inspecting raw Essbase data grids, business users monitor profitability trends, cost variance percentages, and branch performance through intuitive charts and key metrics.

Intermediate Level

Each dashboard tile is powered by an underlying EPM Web Form or MDX query executed against the Essbase block storage (BSO) or aggregate storage (ASO) cube. Global Point of View (POV) filters (Scenario, Year, Period, Version, Entity) allow real-time slicing across the entire dashboard canvas simultaneously.

Advanced Level

Dashboard configuration integrates dynamic cross-dimensional intersections:

- **Account / Driver:** Net Income %, Direct Expenses, Allocated Overhead.
- **Entity / Department:** Retail Chains (BB100, BB200, BB300), Store Brands (QMart, Sporting World, Mountain Adventure).
- **Product Dimension:** Product SKUs (B1001, B1002, B1003, B1004).
- **Time Horizon:** 6-Month Rolling Horizon (January 2016 – June 2016).

Expert Level

At the enterprise scale, PCMCS dashboards leverage ASO dynamic aggregation views to guarantee instant rendering over millions of driver combinations. Solution Architects configure context-sensitive drill-through paths from chart nodes directly into **Rule Balances**, **Allocation Trace**, or **Smart View Ad-Hoc grids** for immediate root-cause auditing.

5. Detailed Interface & UI Element Breakdown

Element Name	UI Type	Purpose & Description	Business Usage & Functional Explanation	Oracle Best Practice
Oracle Header Bar	Header Bar	Displays system branding and application name (`BksML30`).	Confirms active environment and instance context.	Use distinctive environment header colors for Prod vs Non-Prod.
Dashboards Tab	Primary Tab	Active visual analytics canvas workspace.	Accesses dashboard charts, KPI summary cards, and visual analytics.	Limit canvas tiles to 6 widgets per dashboard to preserve speed.
Intelligence Tab	Primary Tab	Analytical tools (Profitability Curves, Allocation Trace).	Inspects cost rule assignments and step-down allocation flows.	Validate rule output via Intelligence views prior to executive review.
Reports Tab	Primary Tab	Financial Reporting (FR) books and Management Reports.	Generates printable statutory board books and formatted PDFs.	Standardize FR templates across all operational business units.
Academy Tab	Primary Tab	Oracle documentation, video tutorials, and reference guides.	User onboarding and feature capability training.	Review Academy release notes after monthly cloud updates.
Refresh Button	Action Button	Re-executes MDX queries across all canvas widgets.	Pulls calculated numbers immediately after allocation job execution.	Click Refresh post rule calculation completion.
Net Income % Charts	Line Chart Widget	Displays 6-month Net Income % trajectory across entities & SKUs.	Identifies branch margin erosion and product trend drops (e.g., June dip).	Maintain consistent color coding for products across all store charts.

Element Name	UI Type	Purpose & Description	Business Usage & Functional Explanation	Oracle Best Practice
Quarter Variance Tiles	KPI Status Tile	Displays percentage shift (+0.19%, -7.53%).	Provides instant executive view of Quarter-over-Quarter variances.	Set conditional visual alerts (Red/Green thresholds).

6. Step-by-Step Configuration Guide

```
[Start Configuration]
        |
        ▼
1. Create Underlying Data Forms / Grids (POV: Jan-Jun 2016, Net Income %)
        |
        ▼
2. Open Dashboard Designer: Navigation -> Dashboards -> Create Dashboard
        |
        ▼
3. Define Grid Layout: Select 2 Rows x 3 Columns Layout Matrix
        |
        ▼
4. Add Chart Components: Drag Line Charts & Status Tiles into Grid
        |
        ▼
5. Map Data Sources: Link Line Charts to Store Forms & Tiles to KPI Queries
        |
        ▼
6. Set Visual Properties: Axes Scales, Legend Titles, Series Colors
        |
        ▼
7. Configure Global POV: Bind Scenario, Year, Version Filters
        |
        ▼
8. Save, Assign Security Permissions, and Publish Canvas
        |
        ▼
[End Configuration]
```

7. End-to-End Analytics Workflow

```
┌─────────────────┐     ┌────────────────────┐     ┌───────────────────────┐
┌────────────────────┐
│ Data Ingestion │ ──> │ Execution Engine  │ ──> │ Aggregate Storage    │ ──> │ Dashboard
Canvas   │
│ (GL Actuals &  │     │ (Allocation Rules │     │ (ASO Cube Calculation│     │ (Visual
Trend      │
│ Operational)   │     │  & Cost Drivers)  │     │  & Ratio Aggregation)│     │  & KPI
Rendering) │
└─────────────────┘     └────────────────────┘     └───────────────────────┘
└────────────────────┘
                                                                                  │
                                                                                  ▼
┌────────────────────┐
                                                                              │ Executive
Decision│
                                                                              │ & Root-Cause
Trace│
└────────────────────┘
```

8. Internal Processing & Data Flow Logic

When an executive opens or refreshes the **Six Months Trending Analysis** dashboard:

1. **MDX Query Generation:** The visual layer converts chart rules into MDX query statements directed at the Essbase cube.
2. **Cross-Dimensional Math Evaluation:**

   $$\textit{Net Income \%} = (\textit{ Net Profit / Direct Revenue }) \times 100$$

   The engine evaluates calculated dynamic accounts across 6 periods for all requested entities.
3. **Asynchronous REST Retrieval:** Dashboard components issue parallel REST calls, eliminating rendering bottlenecks.
4. **Dynamic HTML5 Canvas Drawing:** JSON payload vectors are drawn visually as interactive trend lines and formatted tiles.

9. Real-World Business Examples & Industry Use Cases

Retail & Department Store Chain (Current Scenario)

Tracks product profitability erosion across QMart, Sporting World, and Mountain Adventure stores. Highlights margin declines caused by increased warehousing and logistics allocations during mid-year promotional campaigns.

Banking & Financial Services

Monitors Net Interest Margin (NIM %) across physical branch networks following IT and administrative cost allocations. Quarter-over-quarter KPI tiles highlight shifts in customer acquisition costs.

Healthcare Provider System

Evaluates net margin per patient bed across specialties (Cardiology, Orthopedics) after allocating operating room equipment depreciation and clinical support staff expenses.

10. Consultant Perspective: Implementation Lifecycle

```
┌─────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────┐
│                              CONSULTANT LIFECYCLE                               │
├───────────────────┬───────────────────┬───────────────────┬─────────────────────┤
│ 1. Requirements   │ 2. Design         │ 3. Build & Test   │ 4. Deploy & Support │
│ - Identify KPIs   │ - Layout mockup   │ - Form Creation   │ - Role Security     │
│ - Target Audience │ - Dimension POV   │ - Chart Binding   │ - User Training     │
│ - Refresh Speed   │ - Axis Scaling    │ - Performance Test│ - Maintenance Handover│
└───────────────────┴───────────────────┴───────────────────┴─────────────────────┘
```

11. Best Practices & Performance Optimization

Oracle Technical Recommendation

Always structure underlying dashboard forms with **Sparse Dimensions on Rows** and **Dense Dimensions (e.g., Period/Time) on Columns**. This maximizes Essbase block retrieval efficiency.

- **Widget Density:** Restrict canvases to 4–6 tiles to optimize screen render time.
- **Standardized POV:** Inherit Global POV settings across all widgets to prevent mismatched analytical perspectives.
- **Pre-Calculated Accounts:** Compute ratios in Essbase outline formulas or Rule Sets rather than forcing complex runtime client math.
- **Consistent Palette:** Maintain unified colors for dimensions across adjacent charts (e.g., Product `B1001` always rendered in Blue).

12. Troubleshooting Guide

Problem / Issue	Possible Cause	Resolution	Oracle Recommendation
Tile Shows "No Data Available"	Uncalculated allocation period or missing form slice.	Verify rule execution for Jan–Jun 2016; check form suppression rules.	Audit data via Smart View ad-hoc grid prior to dashboard edit.
Dashboard Loads Slowly (>10s)	Excessive tile count or unaggregated BSO dynamic queries.	Optimize form grids; enable dynamic aggregate views in ASO.	Limit widget count to 6 max per page.

Problem / Issue	Possible Cause	Resolution	Oracle Recommendation
KPI Tile Shows Wrong Ratio	Scale factor mismatch or missing `* 100` outline math.	Correct cell formatting and outline ratio formulas.	Standardize percentage formats at metadata level.
Charts Out of Sync Post Allocation	Web browser caching old query results.	Click the explicit **Refresh** button on the dashboard title bar.	Instruct users to Refresh after allocation batch jobs.

13. Interview Preparation Questions & Answers

Q1: What is the primary purpose of PCMCS Dashboards?

Answer: PCMCS Dashboards deliver visual, interactive executive reporting that converts multi-dimensional cost allocation output into visual charts and KPI tiles. They empower management to analyze profitability drivers and drill into underlying allocation levels without manual query building.

Q2: How do Dashboard widgets link to PCMCS application data?

Answer: Dashboard widgets bind directly to underlying EPM Web Forms or saved Web Grids. When rendered, each widget executes an optimized MDX query against the Essbase cube based on defined row/column intersections and the Global POV.

Q3: What distinguishes a KPI Tile from a Line Chart Widget?

Answer: A KPI Status Tile displays a single variance metric (e.g., `+0.19% Change Over Prior Quarter`) for quick status review. A Line Chart Widget plots multi-period trends across entities or products (e.g., 6-month margin curves).

Q4: Why is Point of View (POV) synchronization essential?

Answer: Global POV synchronization guarantees that selecting a new Scenario, Year, or Version refreshes all canvas widgets simultaneously, preventing data mismatch across charts.

Q5: How can dynamic dashboard query performance be optimized?

Answer: Limit widgets to 4–6 per page, bind charts to optimized forms with block suppression, query pre-aggregated ASO views, and avoid heavy dynamic runtime calculations on web forms.

14. Oracle Certification Exam Practice MCQs

1. What query language is generated when a PCMCS Dashboard chart queries an Aggregate Storage Option (ASO) cube?

A) SQL (Structured Query Language)
B) MDX (Multi-Dimensional eXpression)
C) MAXL Script
D) Calc Script

Correct Answer: B

Explanation: ASO cubes use MDX to dynamically retrieve multi-dimensional slices for dashboard rendering.

2. What action occurs when clicking the "Refresh" button on the PCMCS Dashboard bar?

A) Restarts the underlying Essbase application process.
B) Re-runs the global allocation rule set.
C) Re-executes underlying form queries and repaints visual charts.
D) Clears browser security tokens.

Correct Answer: C

Explanation: The Refresh button re-evaluates web form queries against the database and repaints visual canvas widgets.

3. Which PCMCS top-navigation tab provides Profitability Curves and Allocation Trace?

A) Dashboards
B) Intelligence
C) Reports
D) Academy

Correct Answer: B

Explanation: The Intelligence tab contains advanced analytical tools such as Profitability Curves, Scatter Analysis, and Allocation Trace.

15. Quick Reference Cheat Sheet

```
=========================================================================================
                          ORACLE PCMCS DASHBOARDS CHEAT SHEET
=========================================================================================
NAVIGATION PATH     : Main Menu -> Dashboards -> Select Dashboard Canvas
KEY COMPONENTS      : Line Charts, Bar Charts, Pie Charts, KPI Tiles, Form Grids
PRIMARY PURPOSE     : Executive visualization of allocation & profitability results
MAX RECOMMENDED     : 4 to 6 widgets per canvas for optimal performance
QUERY MECHANISM     : Automatic MDX execution against underlying forms / Essbase views
POV INTEGRATION     : Global POV drives synchronised filtering across all canvas tiles
=========================================================================================
BEST PRACTICES:
 - Keep scale units uniform across adjacent store charts.
 - Pre-calculate ratio accounts in Rule Sets or outline formulas.
 - Ensure sparse members are placed on rows and dense members on columns in source forms.
=========================================================================================
```

16. Frequently Asked Questions (FAQs)

Q1: Can PCMCS Dashboards be exported directly to PDF?

Yes. Dashboards can be printed or exported using built-in EPM print options or standard browser print actions for board deck inclusion.

Q2: How do dynamic filters operate across multiple canvas tiles?

When linked to a Global POV, selecting a member (e.g., changing Year from 2015 to 2016) updates all connected widgets dynamically.

Q3: Can functional administrators control dashboard security access?
Yes. Dashboard artifacts inherit EPM access permissions, allowing security leads to assign read/write privileges by user role or group.

17. Summary & Key Takeaways

- **Executive Insight:** PCMCS Dashboards transform complex cost allocations into interactive visual trend charts and KPI tiles.
- **Form-Driven Data:** Visual tiles map directly to EPM Web Forms and underlying Essbase cross-dimensional intersections.
- **Architectural Rigor:** Solutions Consultants must balance visual appeal with performance by optimizing form structures and enforcing uniform POV management.

18. Practical Allocation Calculation Example

The following detailed walkthrough illustrates how a single visual data point on the **Net Income % | Sporting World** line chart is calculated inside PCMCS and plotted onto the dashboard canvas.

Business Scenario: Shared Corporate Overhead Allocation

Target Store: Sporting World (Product Branch `B1001`)
Period: June 2016
Objective: Compute true branch Net Income % after allocating shared corporate warehousing expenses.

Step 1: Raw Financial Ingestion

- **Sporting World Direct Revenue:** $500,000
- **Sporting World Direct Expenses:** $300,000
- **Shared Warehousing Cost Pool:** $100,000
- **Warehouse Usage Statistic:** Total Chain Sq. Ft. = 10,000 | Sporting World Share = 4,000 Sq. Ft. (40%)

Step 2: Rule Set Allocation Processing

$$\textit{Allocated Overhead} = \textit{Total Pool} \times (\textit{Branch Sq. Ft.} / \textit{Total Sq. Ft.})$$
$$\textit{Allocated Overhead} = \$100{,}000 \times (4{,}000 / 10{,}000) = \$40{,}000$$

Step 3: Profitability & Ratio Computation

$$\textit{Net Profit} = \textit{Direct Revenue} - \textit{Direct Expenses} - \textit{Allocated Overhead}$$
$$\textit{Net Profit} = \$500{,}000 - \$300{,}000 - \$40{,}000 = \$160{,}000$$

$$\textit{Net Income \%} = (\textit{Net Profit} / \textit{Direct Revenue}) \times 100$$
$$\textit{Net Income \%} = (\$160{,}000 / \$500{,}000) \times 100 = 32\%$$

Step 4: Visual Canvas Rendering

```
Net Income % | Sporting World by Product

  %  |
 100 |
  80 |
  60 |
  40 |             /────────────────  20 |            /                    0
└───┬──────────┬──────────┬──────┴─── Period
       Jan 2016   Feb 2016   ...   June 2016 (Data Node: B1001 = 32%)
```

When refreshed, the PCMCS Dashboard issues an MDX query for Product `B1001` in `June 2016`, retrieves the calculated value **32%**, and plots the final trend node on the visual line graph.

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